the fear of the East India Company's legacy is so deep-rooted that most Indian leaders would rather India not be dependent on any country. This desire has always conflicted with reality. India does not produce everything it needs and is one of the leading importers of oil and gas and defence equipment. According to data compiled by the US Energy Information Administration (EIA), India imports approximately 4.3 million barrels of crude oil per day and by 2040 it will need ten million barrels of oil per day.[25] According to data on international arms transfers published by Stockholm International Peace Research Institute (SIPRI), between 2010 and 2014 India accounted for 15 per cent of the volume of global arms imports, more than three times as much as China. This was up from the period between 2005 and 2009 when India accounted for 7 per cent of global arms imports.[26] India also requires large doses of foreign investment and access to the latest foreign technologies.

India resolved its dilemma of wanting autarky while needing external support with sometimes contradictory policies and even hypocritical practices. For example, foreign aid and investment are described as impinging on India's independence but that has not prevented successive governments from accepting both. In effect, self-sufficiency has been the aspiration even as pragmatic compromise has led Indians to get what they can from whatever source will let them have it. In the policy realm, the aspiration finds reflection in programmes such as 'import substitution' that India adopted in its initial years and the 'Make in India' slogan of India's current prime minister, Narendra Modi. In practice, however, exceptions and adjustments rule the roost and India has neither closed itself from the global economy nor refused to let principle come in the way of its immediate needs.

A major example of practicality in India's economic approach lies in the adjustments made over time to the country's agriculture policy. During the 1950s and 1960s India's wheat production was insufficient to meet